# SOP-001 Deviation Handling

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## 1. Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure establishes the mandatory process for identifying, documenting, triaging, and investigating deviations occurring during GMP manufacturing, packaging, testing, and storage operations at Novacure Labs.

## 2. Scope

This procedure applies to all operational personnel, quality control analysts, warehouse operators, and validation engineers across all commercial and clinical production facilities at Novacure Labs.

## 3. Responsibilities

Priya Rao, QA Lead, owns deviation management. The QA Lead is responsible for deviation classification, root-cause investigation approvals, and corrective action assignment. Department heads must ensure immediate reporting.

## 4. Procedure - Notification and Reporting

Every deviation must be reported to QA within 24 hours of discovery. The reporting associate must execute immediate containment to prevent non-conforming product distribution and initiate an electronic deviation record in the QMS.

## 5. Procedure - Investigation and Root Cause

For critical and major deviations, a formal root-cause analysis must be conducted using Ishikawa fishbone diagrams or 5-Why methodology. The investigation must be completed and submitted for QA review within 30 calendar days.

## 6. Batch Disposition and Record Retention

Batches implicated in open deviations cannot be released for commercial distribution until all root-cause evaluations are concluded and signed off by Quality Assurance leadership. All records must be retained for at least 10 years.